

LAND SLUGS

With no shell to retreat into, slugs have to hide, emerging at night to feed. Some live underground. Although seen as pests for devouring garden plants and farm crops, slugs play a useful part in breaking down rotting vegetation.



COMMON GARDEN SLUG

KERRY SPOTTED SLUG

BLACK SLUG

SEA SLUGS

As wobbly as jelly and often as brightly coloured, sea slugs creep over seabeds and corals. Some can swim in a clumsy fashion. They carry gills, or breathing organs, such as feathers or spikes on their backs.



VARICOSE SEA SLUG

SPANISH DANCER

ANNA'S SEA SLUG

HEADSHIELD SLUG

OPALESCENT SEA SLUG

ELEGANT SEA SLUG

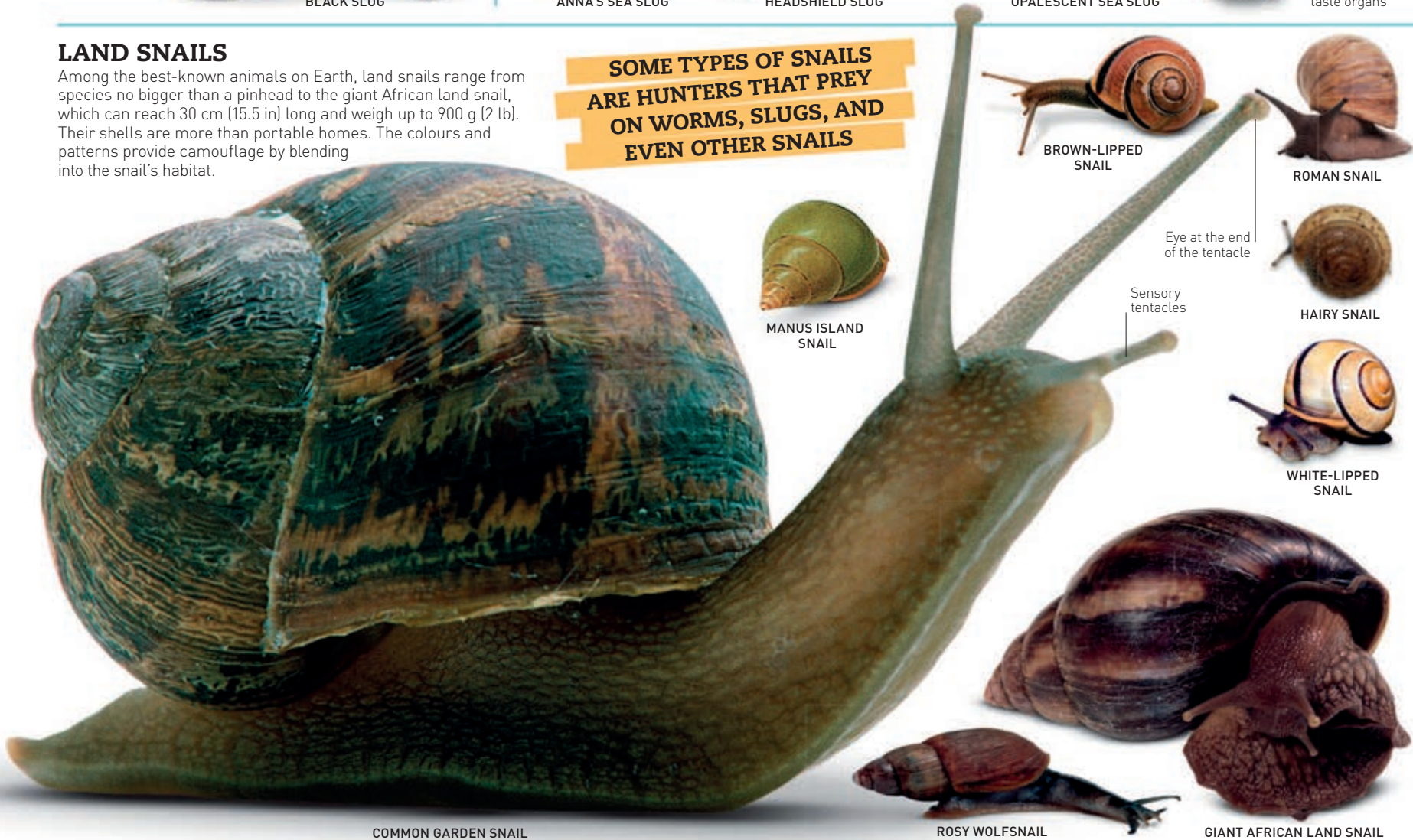
Gills

Smell or taste organs

LAND SNAILS

Among the best-known animals on Earth, land snails range from species no bigger than a pinhead to the giant African land snail, which can reach 30 cm (15.5 in) long and weigh up to 900 g (2 lb). Their shells are more than portable homes. The colours and patterns provide camouflage by blending into the snail's habitat.

SOME TYPES OF SNAILS ARE HUNTERS THAT PREY ON WORMS, SLUGS, AND EVEN OTHER SNAILS



COMMON GARDEN SNAIL

BROWN-LIPPED SNAIL

ROMAN SNAIL

HAIRY SNAIL

WHITE-LIPPED SNAIL

ROSY WOLFSNAIL

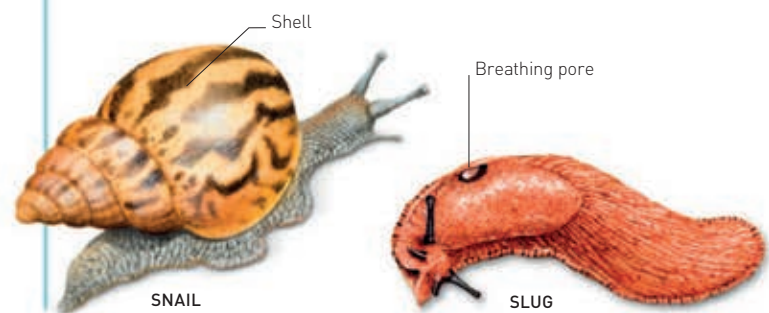
GIANT AFRICAN LAND SNAIL

Slugs and snails

Leaving pathways of shining slime made by their own bodies, land slugs and snails are familiar in damp places almost all over the world. Less often seen, except sometimes as aquarium pets, are slugs and snails that live in water. Many of these, especially species from warm oceans, are vividly coloured or have fantastically shaped shells.

WHAT'S THE DIFFERENCE?

The bodies of slugs and snails look very alike, but a telltale feature lies beneath a snail's shell. This is a small hump containing most of the snail's internal organs. Some slugs have a tiny internal shell that serves as a calcium store.



SNAIL

SLUG